DJBILBOX BEATS / HUMPIRE

OCTOPUS

Abyssal synthesizer: kraken subs, bubble plucks, coral bells, abyss pads, ink reese, tentacle leads, siren choirs and whale song from eight synthesis engines.

Version 1.0 - Windows (VST3) and macOS (VST3 / Audio Unit) - Royalty-free license

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OCTOPUS

Abyssal synthesizer: kraken subs, bubble plucks, coral bells, abyss pads, ink reese, tentacle leads, siren choirs and whale song from eight synthesis engines.

Type	Synthesizer (instrument)
Format	VST3 64-bit (Windows); VST3 + Audio Unit, universal (macOS)
Brand / developer	HUMPIRE by DJBILBOX BEATS
Version	1.0
Factory presets	70
Latency	0 samples

Overview

OCTOPUS is a synthesizer sold under the HUMPIRE brand by DJBILBOX BEATS. It uses no samples. Every sound is generated in real time by one of eight engines: Kraken Sub (a sine sub with a pitch “knock” and saturation), Bubble Pluck (a sine whose pitch rises quickly, like a bubble), Coral Bells (an FM bell), Abyss Pad (five detuned saws with breath noise and a breathing filter), Ink Reese (detuned saws with a sub and saturation), Tentacle Lead (two pulse waves with a modulated width), Siren Choir (five saws through vowel formants) and Whale Song (a sine with slow glissandos, a harmonic and a resonance).

Five character controls (TONE, BODY, BRIGHT, WIDTH, TEXTURE) reshape each engine. The sound then goes through a multimode filter with its own envelope, an amplitude envelope, an LFO and an effects chain: distortion, chorus, ping-pong delay and reverb. The character is deep, wet and underwater.

OCTOPUS targets dark Trap and Drill sub lines, ambient and cinematic beds, Lo-Fi textures and sound design. 44 presets load in Poly mode with up to 16 voices; 26 load in Mono mode for single-note lines.

Quick start in FL Studio

1. In the **Channel rack**, click **+** and choose **OCTOPUS** (vendor **DJBILBOX BEATS**). You can also drag it from the **Plugin database > Generators** browser.
2. The plugin opens on **OCTOPUS - Init Patch**: the Kraken Sub engine in Poly mode.
3. Click the **folder icon** at the left of the preset display. Pick a bank, then a preset. You can also step through all 70 presets with the **<** and **>** arrows.
4. Play from your MIDI keyboard or draw notes in the **Piano roll**. The on-screen keyboard covers MIDI notes 36 to 84 (C3 to C7 in FL Studio naming, where middle C is C5).
5. Shape the sound with the main controls:
   - **TONE, BODY, BRIGHT, WIDTH, TEXTURE**: the small knobs under the title, which reshape the selected engine.
   - **CUTOFF**: the cutoff of the filter. Turn it down for a darker sound.
   - **GLIDE**: slide time between notes. Leave it at zero for straight notes.
6. Adjust **VOLUME** to set the level, then click the **disk icon** to save your own version.

Interface

The window opens at 1000 x 746 pixels. Drag the bottom-right corner to resize it from 50% to 200%. The proportions stay fixed.

Preset display (top center). From left to right: the folder icon (preset menu), the **<** arrow, the current preset name, the **>** arrow and the disk icon (save). The arrows wrap around from the last preset to the first.

EXPANSION cassette (top left). Clicking the cassette opens an information message about upcoming expansion packs. No expansion content is included with version 1.0.

Logo (top right). The DJBILBOXBEATS name and the DB logo.

Center. The octopus camel artwork, the OCTOPUS title and “By Humpire”. The dotted grilles on each side of the artwork are decorative.

LFO section (left). RATE and **AMOUNT** set the LFO speed and depth. **TRANSPOSE**, in the same row, is the global transposition (-12 to +12 semitones). It is not an LFO control.

AMP ENVELOPE (left, below the LFO). Four sliders: **ATTACK, DECAY, SUSTAIN, RELEASE**.

Character row (center, under the title). Seven small knobs, left to right: **TONE, BODY, BRIGHT, WIDTH, TEXTURE, RES** (filter resonance) and **ENV AMT** (filter envelope depth). **GLIDE** and **CUTOFF** are two larger knobs to their right.

FILTER ENVELOPE (top right). Five vertical sliders: **ATK, DEC, SUS, REL** and **VELOCITY** (velocity sensitivity of the level). The **VOLUME** knob sits below them.

Effects (right). REVERB, CHORUS, DISTORTION on the upper row. **DLY MIX** (delay level), **DLY TIME** and **FEEDBACK** (delay repeats) on the lower row.

Menu row. Five drop-down menus, each with a caption: **ENGINE** (Waveform), **LFO SHAPE**, **LFO DESTINATION**, **FILTER TYPE** and **VOICE MODE**. Each menu shows its current value.

Wheels. Pitch Bend springs back to the center when you release it. **Modulation** stays where you leave it.

On-screen keyboard. Click a key to play it. Velocity follows the click position: click near the bottom of a key for a louder note. The keyboard covers MIDI notes 36 to 84 (four octaves plus one key). The key labels on screen run from C1 to C5, with middle C labeled C3; in FL Studio naming, where middle C is C5, the same range is C3 to C7. It does not scroll. For notes outside this range, use a MIDI controller or the Piano roll.

Mouse gestures. Drag a knob up or right to increase it. Drag sliders and wheels vertically. Double-click any knob or slider to return it to its default value. The mouse wheel also adjusts controls. A value bubble appears while you drag.

Parameters

Signal flow: engine, then filter, then amplitude envelope (per voice). The voices are summed, then processed by Distortion, Chorus, Delay and Reverb. A DC blocker and a soft limiter protect the output.

OCTOPUS exposes 35 automatable parameters. The host name is shown in parentheses when it differs from the panel label.

Parameter	Range	Default	Function
ENGINE (Waveform menu)	Kraken Sub, Bubble Pluck, Coral Bells, Abyss Pad, Ink Reese, Tentacle Lead, Siren Choir, Whale Song	Kraken Sub	Selects the synthesis engine.
TONE	0 to 1	50 %	Character control 1. Engine-dependent (see the table below).

Parameter	Range	Default	Function
BODY	0 to 1	50 %	Character control 2. Engine-dependent.
BRIGHT (Brightness)	0 to 1	50 %	Character control 3 (brightness). Engine-dependent.
WIDTH	0 to 1	30 %	Character control 4. Engine-dependent (detune, vibrato, sweep speed…). It is not a stereo width control.
TEXTURE	0 to 1	20 %	Character control 5. Engine-dependent (noise, click, saturation…).
CUTOFF (Filter)	40 to 18,000 Hz	9,000 Hz	Filter cutoff. The cutoff follows the keyboard by 25% around middle C.
RES (Resonance)	0 to 1	15 %	Filter resonance.
FILTER TYPE (menu)	Low Pass, High Pass, Band Pass	Low Pass	Filter mode (state-variable filter, 12 dB per octave). Band Pass gets a small level boost.
ENV AMT (Filter Env Amount)	0 to 1	0 %	Filter envelope depth. At 100 % the envelope opens the cutoff up to 5 octaves. At 0 the filter envelope has no effect.
ATK (Filter Attack)	0.002 to 3 s	0.002 s	Filter envelope attack time.
DEC (Filter Decay)	0.02 to 4 s	0.3 s	Filter envelope decay time.
SUS (Filter Sustain)	0 to 1	0 %	Filter envelope sustain level.
REL (Filter Release)	0.02 to 4 s	0.3 s	Filter envelope release time.
VELOCITY (Velocity Sensitivity)	0 to 1	50 %	How much note velocity changes the level. 0: all notes at the same level. 1: full velocity response.
ATTACK	0.001 to 5 s	0.01 s	Amplitude envelope attack time.
DECAY	0.01 to 5 s	0.4 s	Amplitude envelope decay time.
SUSTAIN	0 to 1	70 %	Amplitude envelope sustain level.
RELEASE	0.02 to 8 s	0.4 s	Amplitude envelope release time.
VOLUME	0 to 1 (shown in dB)	0.7 (-3.1 dB)	Output level of each voice, before the effects.

Parameter	Range	Default	Function
GLIDE	0 to 2 s	0 s	Portamento. The value is roughly the slide time in seconds. Each new note slides from the pitch of the previous note, in Mono and in Poly mode. 0 turns glide off.
TRANSPOSE	-12 to +12 semitones	0	Global transposition in whole semitones.
RATE (LFO Rate)	0.05 to 20 Hz	4 Hz	LFO speed. Not tempo-synced. The LFO restarts at every new note.
AMOUNT (LFO Amount)	0 to 1	0 %	LFO depth. The mod wheel (on-screen or MIDI CC1) adds up to 0.8 to this value.
LFO SHAPE (LFO Source menu)	Sine, Triangle, Saw, Square, Sample&Hold	Sine	LFO shape. Sample&Hold picks a new random value once per cycle.
LFO DESTINATION (Destination menu)	Pitch, Filter, Amp, Timbre	Pitch	LFO target. Pitch: up to +/-1 semitone (vibrato). Filter: up to +/-3 octaves (wobble). Amp: up to 50% level dip (tremolo). Timbre: moves all five character controls by up to +/-0.5.
VOICE MODE (Mono/Poly menu)	Poly, Mono	Poly	Poly: up to 16 notes at once. Mono: one note at a time, last-note priority.
DISTORTION	0 to 1	0 %	Saturation on the summed output, with automatic level compensation.
CHORUS	0 to 1	0 %	Stereo chorus mix (slow, fixed rate).
DLY MIX (Delay Mix)	0 to 1	0 %	Level of the ping-pong delay.
DLY TIME (Delay Time)	0.05 to 1 s	0.35 s	Delay time in seconds. Not tempo-synced: for a quarter note, use 60 / BPM (0.5 s at 120 BPM); halve it for an eighth note.
FEEDBACK (Delay Feedback)	0 to 0.9	35 %	Number of delay repeats (0 to 90% feedback).
REVERB	0 to 1	25 %	Reverb amount. Higher values also enlarge the room.
Pitch Bend wheel (Pitch Bend)	-1 to +1	0	On-screen pitch bend, +/-2 semitones. Adds to MIDI pitch bend.

Parameter	Range	Default	Function
Mod Wheel	0 to 1	0 %	On-screen mod wheel. Adds up to +0.8 to the LFO AMOUNT; the larger of this wheel and MIDI CC1 applies.

Character controls by engine

Engine	TONE	BODY	BRIGHT	WIDTH	TEXTURE
Kraken Sub	Pitch “knock” at the attack	Adds the octave harmonic	Attack click	No effect	Saturation
Bubble Pluck	Pitch rise amount	Length of the bubble (rise time and decay)	Second harmonic level	No effect	Attack click
Coral Bells	Modulator ratio (1.4 to 4.5)	Ring length	FM depth (bell brightness)	Detune between the two carriers	Attack noise
Abyss Pad	No effect	Level of a sine one octave below	Breathing low-pass opening	Detune spread of the five saws	Breath noise
Ink Reese	Sub level	Detune amount	Low-pass opening	Saturation drive	Noise
Tentacle Lead	Depth of the pulse-width modulation	Detune of the second pulse	Low-pass opening	Speed of the pulse-width modulation (0.3 to 5.3 Hz)	Level of a sine one octave below
Siren Choir	Vowel (a, o, u, i)	Formant level	Low-pass opening	Detune spread of the five saws	Noise
Whale Song	Speed of the slow glissando (0.12 to 0.62 Hz)	Third harmonic level	Second harmonic level	Depth of the glissando	Level of the resonant noise at twice the pitch

Factory presets

OCTOPUS includes 70 factory presets in 7 banks of 10. 44 presets load in Poly mode and 26 in Mono mode. Mono presets: Kraken Sub (all 10); Ink Reese & Leads (8 of 10); Siren Choir (1 of 10); Whale Song (7 of 10). 9 presets load with a glide.

Kraken Sub: Kraken Sub, Deep Trench, Pressure Drop, Long Slide Sub, Dirty Kraken, Smooth Tide, Hard Knock Reef, Short Wave, Rumble Below, Submarine.

Bubbles & Drops: Bubble Pluck, Water Drop, Deep Bloop, Rising Bubbles, Reef Marimba, Aqua Arp, Pop Pop, Glass Bubble, Tide Pool, Foam.

Coral Bells: Coral Bell, Shell Chimes, Glass Jellyfish, Pearl, Sunken Bell, Music Box Sea, Echo Chamber, Drift Chimes, Hollow Kalimba, Sonar Ping.

Abyss Pads: Abyss Pad, Ink Cloud, Bioluminescence, Rising Current, Kelp Forest, Dark Water, Surface Light, Whisper Current, Pulse Of The Deep, Drowned Strings.

Ink Reese & Leads: Ink Reese, Eel Bass, Wobble Reef, Octopus Bass, Tentacle Lead, Chrome Squid, Pulse Current, Slow Wave Lead, Sea Cave Lead, Pulse Stab.

Siren Choir: Siren Choir, Ooo Sirens, Ah Mermaids, Ee Deep, Vowel Tide, Whisper Reef, Low Sirens, Lure Song, Coral Chorale, Hollow Chant.

Whale Song: Whale Song, Humpback, Blue Whale Call, Sonar Sweep, Dolphin Click, Siren Of The Deep, Ghost Ship, Distant Pod, Ocean Drone, Sperm Song.

Loading a preset first resets every parameter to its default value, then applies the preset. The two wheels are not changed.

User presets. Click the disk icon to save the current sound as a `.ocpreset` file. The default folder is `DJBILBOX BEATS/OCTOPUS/Presets` inside your Documents folder (Windows and macOS). Files in this folder appear in the **User** submenu of the preset menu. Use **Open a .ocpreset file…** in the same menu to load a file from another location. The preset display shows the file name.

The host also sees the 70 factory presets as a program list. Your project saves the full state of the plugin, including the preset name.

Production tips

1. **Trap and Drill subs.** Start from **Kraken Sub** or **Long Slide Sub** (Kraken Sub bank). Raise TONE for a harder knock on short notes. Add TEXTURE or DISTORTION so the sub stays audible on phone speakers.
2. **Slides.** Presets such as **Long Slide Sub** and **Pressure Drop** use glide. For slides on selected notes only, keep GLIDE at 0 and automate it before the notes that should slide.
3. **Bubbles and drops.** The Bubbles & Drops bank loads in Poly mode: write short staccato notes. BODY sets the length of each bubble.
4. **Underwater bells.** On the Coral Bells engine, TONE sets the bell ratio and BRIGHT the FM depth. Add REVERB and DLY MIX for a wet space.
5. **Abyss pads.** Raise the ATTACK and RELEASE sliders and keep the filter moving with the LFO set to Filter.
6. **Whale song.** The Whale Song engine glides on its own: TONE sets how fast, WIDTH how far. Play long notes and add reverb.
7. **Siren choir.** TONE selects the vowel; set LFO DESTINATION to Timbre to make it move.
8. **Tempo-matched delay.** DLY TIME is in seconds. Use 60 / BPM for a quarter note.

MIDI, automation and performance

Notes and channels. OCTOPUS responds to all 128 MIDI notes on any MIDI channel. Velocity controls the level according to the VELOCITY slider.

Polyphony. Up to 16 voices in Poly mode. When you play a 17th note, a voice is taken over and cut immediately. In Mono mode, each new note stops the previous one (last-note priority). Releasing the newest note does not bring back an earlier note that you still hold.

Pitch bend. MIDI pitch bend covers +/-2 semitones. The on-screen Pitch Bend wheel adds another +/-2 semitones.

Mod wheel (CC1). CC1 raises the LFO depth, like the on-screen Modulation wheel. When both are used, the higher value wins. CC1 acts on the notes that are sounding when the message arrives, so move the wheel while you play. For repeatable results in a song, automate the on-screen **Mod Wheel** parameter instead. CC121 (reset all controllers) returns the MIDI mod wheel to zero.

Other MIDI. All Notes Off and All Sound Off messages stop the sound. Aftertouch is ignored.

Automation in FL Studio. All 35 parameters can be automated. Move a control in the plugin, then use **Tools > Last tweaked > Create automation clip**. Use **Tools > Last tweaked > Link to controller** to assign a hardware knob. Level, pitch, bend and cutoff changes are smoothed to avoid clicks.

Latency and tail. The plugin adds no latency (0 samples). It reports a 12-second tail to the host so reverb and delay trails are not cut when rendering.

CPU. OCTOPUS uses no samples. Effects set to zero are bypassed and cost no CPU. The plugin works at 44.1, 48, 88.2 and 96 kHz.

FAQ

I hear nothing, or almost nothing, in the Kraken Sub bank. These are Mono presets with low notes. Check VOLUME and CUTOFF, and play from a MIDI keyboard or the Piano roll if the notes are below the on-screen keyboard range.

My chord only plays one note. The VOICE MODE menu is set to Mono, which is the default for the sub, lead and whale presets. Switch it to Poly (up to 16 voices).

Short presets sound quiet. Very short presets have less energy. Raise VOLUME.

OCTOPUS does not appear in FL Studio. Open **Options > Manage plugins**, check that `C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3` is in the search paths, then click **Find installed plugins**. The plugin is listed as **OCTOPUS** under **DJBILBOX BEATS**. It is an instrument: load it in the Channel rack, not in a Mixer insert slot.

Where do I install it on macOS? Copy the VST3 to `/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/VST3` and the Audio Unit to `/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins/Components`, then rescan plugins in your host. Both are universal builds.

Is the delay tempo-synced? No. Delay time is in seconds (0.05 to 1 s), and the LFO runs in Hz (0.05 to 20 Hz).